

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Area and volume	Medium

Question

A cylinder has a diameter of **8** inches and a height of **12** inches. What is the volume, in cubic inches, of the cylinder?

Answer

- A. **16π**
- B. **96π**
- C. **192π**
- D. **768π**

Correct Answer: C

Rationale

Choice C is correct. The base of a cylinder is a circle with a diameter equal to the diameter of the cylinder. The volume, **V** , of a cylinder can be found by multiplying the area of the circular base, **A** , by the height of the cylinder, **h** , or **$V = Ah$** . The area of a circle can be found using the formula **$A = \pi r^2$** , where **r** is the radius of the circle. It's given that the diameter of the cylinder is **8** inches. Thus, the radius of this circle is **4** inches. Therefore, the area of the circular base of the cylinder is **$A = \pi(4)^2$** , or **16π** square inches. It's given that the height **h** of the cylinder is **12** inches. Substituting **16π** for **A** and **12** for **h** in the formula **$V = Ah$** gives **$V = 16\pi(12)$** , or **192π** cubic inches.

Choice A is incorrect. This is the area of the circular base of the cylinder.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from using **8**, instead of **16**, as the value of **r^2** in the formula for the area of a circle.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from using **8**, instead of **4**, for the radius of the circular base.